

English

Teaching and Learning Syllabus

Grades 1 to 6



Mauritius Institute of Education
under the aegis of
Ministry of Education and Human Resources, Tertiary Education and Scientific Research

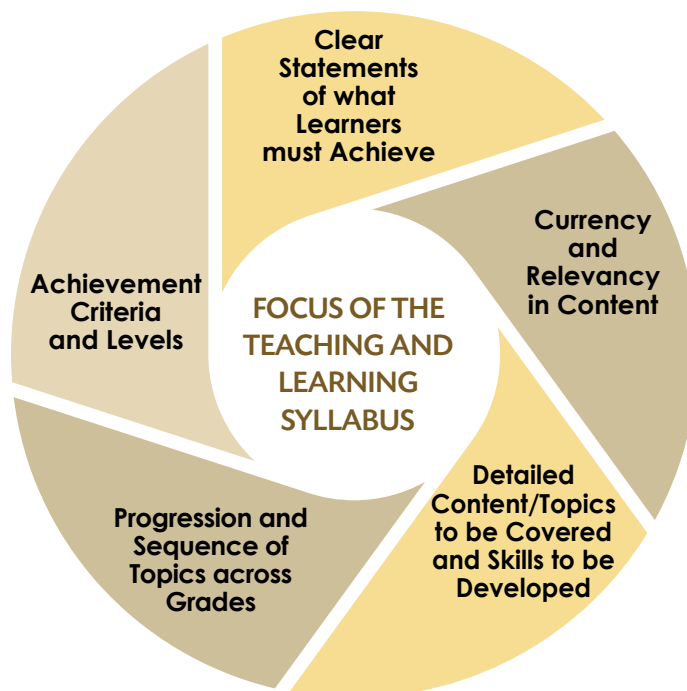


Teaching and Learning Syllabus

English

The Teaching and Learning Syllabus refers to the content of what is to be taught, and to the knowledge, skills, competencies, attitudes and values that are to be developed. It articulates concisely the specific learning outcomes for each grade as per the NCF 2015 and features achievable learning outcomes that represent a Teaching and Learning road map.

- **The focus of the TLS**



- **Clear statements of what learners must achieve**

The TLS spells out the specific learning outcomes that learners are expected to achieve progressively in terms of knowledge, understanding, skills, 21st Century Competencies, attitudes and values during each year of schooling, from Grades 1 to 6.

- **Currency and relevancy in content**

The TLS ensures currency and relevance of content and acquisition of developmentally-appropriate concepts and skills.

- **Detailed content/topics to be covered and skills to be developed**

The TLS details the content and topics to be covered as well as the skills to be developed for each grade while addressing the problem of curriculum overload and stress.

- **Progression and sequence of topics across grades**

The TLS outlines the scope and sequence of the specific learning outcomes for each grade. It indicates the grade in which knowledge, concepts, skills and processes related to the learning outcomes are introduced, based on a spiral curriculum. The learning outcomes are progressively sequenced across grades.

- **Achievement criteria and levels**

The TLS defines assessment criteria that are scaffolded and represent clear measurable outcomes. The levels reflect the competencies in terms of knowledge, skills, values and attitudes expected to have been acquired by learners. The development of achievement levels are meant to assist in the differentiation of teaching, learning and assessment so that the curriculum is accessible to all learners.

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RATIONALE

The English Teaching and Learning Syllabus is a statement of the competencies that learners should acquire in the English language at each stage of their primary schooling. This document establishes the pathway towards the attainment of broader curricular goals as given in the National Curriculum Framework. With competencies for each skill detailed and sequenced from grades 1 to 6, the teaching and learning syllabus serves as a guide for both educators and curriculum developers. It also sets the pace for teaching and learning through content that is graded according to the degree of difficulty and age of learners for whom English is not the first language. Moreover, by presenting the language learning process as a continuum, the syllabus provides an indicative time frame for the development of language skills and competencies in English. As such, educators will find it a useful document to plan and conduct assessment of learning.

The English Teaching and Learning Syllabus, albeit being a significant tool for educators and textbook writers, is also a document that will interest other stakeholders. Given the way in which the learning of English has been mapped out, parents and stakeholders involved in education at primary level may draw from the document for their respective purposes.

SCOPE AND SEQUENCE OF THE ENGLISH SYLLABUS

The English syllabus focuses on the development of the four language skills, namely listening, speaking, reading and writing. It states the language competencies in English that should be developed at different levels. Its aim is to ensure that learners develop an appreciable level of proficiency and literacy in English so that they have a solid foundation for further learning at secondary level and display relative ease when they communicate in the target language. The teaching of grammar is embedded within the competencies. It is understood that a sound knowledge of grammar is a requisite to understanding as well as using language effectively and accurately. At primary level, the emphasis is on usage rather than rule memorisation. Learners will therefore be taught basic rules in context and through meaningful tasks. With the added emphasis on communication skills, learners will be provided with ample opportunities for oral practice in varied situations.

Developing the right attitude towards and an interest in learning English is also a key feature of the syllabus which is premised on the understanding that learners who find the learning of English an engaging experience are motivated to learn the language. The syllabus stresses the need to create an environment that is conducive to learning English and to involve learners in activities that make learning meaningful. It is also essential that learners have access to good quality and attractive reading materials.

THE DEVELOPMENT OF 21ST CENTURY COMPETENCIES AND ENGLISH

A knowledge of English and fluency in the language are key to achieving the 21st Century competencies as outlined in the NCF. Given that English is an international language, the language of technology and the medium of instruction in our country, learners who become proficient users of English will communicate with more ease and confidence. Their learning experiences will be enhanced as they will understand instruction and access information from different media more easily. They will engage in problem solving by analysing and synthesizing information from various sources. Further, through the study of a range of literary texts, learners will develop critical and creative thinking. They will also learn to value and appreciate different cultures and thereby grow respectful towards differences. As fluent users of the English language, learners will also socialise with ease. As such, the added advantage for our learners is that they hold higher chances of becoming successful global citizens.

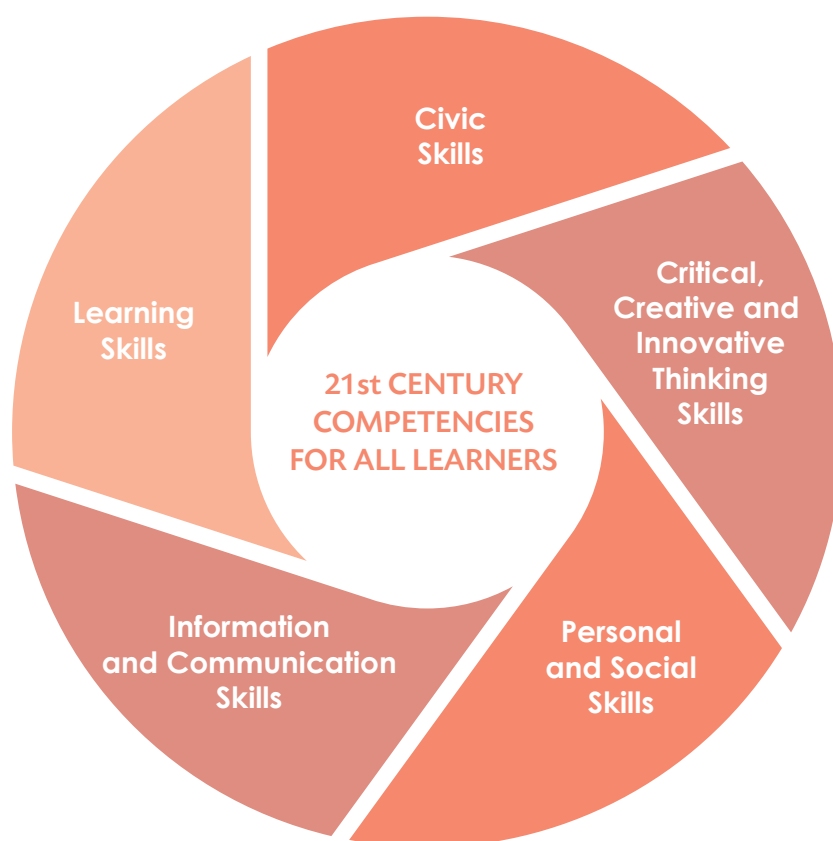


Figure 1: 21st Century Competencies for All Learners

EXPECTED LEARNING OUTCOMES IN ENGLISH

By the end of Grade 6, learners will be able to:

- Demonstrate ease and willingness to use the English language
- Listen to familiar aural texts/ messages with understanding
- Express their ideas on familiar topics and topics of interest, both orally and in writing, with relative fluency
- Vary pitch and tone, and pronounce correctly while speaking and reading aloud
- Read fluently and derive meaning from age-appropriate texts
- Provide personal and some critical response to texts
- Access information from common forms of media
- Produce different types of texts using appropriate conventions

The teaching and learning syllabus for English is divided into three sub-sections, namely language skills, grammar and phonics, and details what should be taught at different levels of primary schooling.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

This section lists the competencies that learners are expected to develop with respect to the four language skills, namely listening, speaking, reading and writing. As competency development is a process, the starting and end points are indicated through the use of different shades of grey along a continuum. In the grade where the development of a competency begins, the lightest shade of grey is used. In the grade where it is expected that the competency has been acquired, the darkest shade of grey is used. In the intermediary stages, the competency is further developed through the use of materials (e.g. texts) and tasks that increase in level of difficulty.

- Key for shading



When 6 shades of grey are used, it means that the competency is to be developed gradually, using increasingly complex texts from Grade 1 up to Grade 6.

When the shading is done for specific grades, the competency is developed in the grade in which the shading starts and is expected to have been acquired in the grade in which the shading is the darkest.

Note: When a competency is expected to be acquired before Grade 6 (i.e. the shading is the darkest in any other grade), this competency should be used and displayed by the learners in activities set by the teacher thereafter.

NCF ENGLISH - SYLLABUS 2015								
Listening	Learning Outcomes	Competencies, attitude and behaviour	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
	LO 1:							
	Demonstrate the ability to recognise the	Recognise and identify everyday sounds and noises (human and non-human, verbal and non-verbal)						
	English language and identify sounds	Recognise when the English language is being used						
		Recognise the different sounds of the English language (e.g the different consonants, vowels, consonant clusters and vowel combinations of the English language)						
	LO 2:							
	Demonstrate active listening	Identify different types of aural texts (e.g. weather forecast, cyclone warning, news bulletin, advertisement, poem, song, nursery rhyme, story, conversation)						

		Enjoy listening to different types of aural texts (e.g. poem, song, story)							
		Listen attentively (e.g. by establishing and sustaining eye contact, adopting and maintaining an appropriate posture and facial expression)							
		Show awareness that intonation patterns indicate different sentence forms (e.g. affirmative, interrogative, negative, exclamative)							
		Follow basic norms and conventions whilst listening (e.g. by avoiding to interrupt, actively listening, taking turns to respond)							
		Follow appropriate norms and conventions whilst listening (e.g. by avoiding to make comments if not required, abstaining from being judgmental, responding accordingly using appropriate verbal/non-verbal cues, seeking clarification if needed, respecting diverging views)							
		Listen over a sustained period of time, i.e. throughout the duration of an aural text (e.g. reading of a Big Book, instructions, story, extract of news bulletin)							
		Listen to and recognise rhyming words in aural texts (e.g. a poem, a nursery rhyme, a song, a story)							
		Respond appropriately to different speech acts (e.g. requests, directions, instructions)							
	LO 3:								
	Demonstrate ability to listen with understanding	Show understanding of statements and questions by responding non-verbally (e.g. nodding) and using yes/no							
		Show understanding of statements and questions by responding verbally (e.g. short answers, longer responses)							
		Recognise different registers (formal/informal speech)							

		Identify topic/theme of aural texts						
		Follow interaction between two or more people (e.g. pair work, group work, conversation, play, talk)						
		Show understanding of key vocabulary and phrases in context and with visual support						
		Show understanding of key vocabulary and phrases in context without visual support						
		Show understanding of aural texts dealing with familiar topics or topics of interest with visual support						
		Show understanding of aural texts dealing with familiar topics or topics of interest without visual support						
		Make predictions based on what has already been heard (e.g. by responding to questions like 'what happens next')						
		Identify information related to characters, setting and plot (e.g. in fairy tales, stories)						
		Identify the purpose of aural texts (e.g. to instruct, to inform, to persuade, to entertain)						
		Show understanding and appreciation of different types of aural texts (e.g. poems, nursery rhymes, stories, songs, literary selections, conversations, news bulletins, talks, debates, announcements)						
		Listen for main ideas/gist						
		Listen for details (e.g. by identifying additional details provided, like descriptive adjectives)						
		Infer the mood and feelings of speakers (i.e. through their use of tone, pitch, volume, pace, pause)						
		Infer meaning from aural texts based on phonological cues (i.e. pace, tone)						
	LO 4:							
	Demonstrate the ability to listen critically	Show ability to provide simple personal response to different types of aural texts						

Speaking	Learning outcomes	Competencies, attitude and behaviour	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
	LO 1							
	Demonstrate willingness and enthusiasm to participate in the English lesson	Join in to recite nursery rhymes/poems and sing songs						
		Respond non-verbally to input in the English language (i.e. through body language and facial expression)						
		Respond verbally to input in the English language (e.g. yes/no, monosyllabic words)						
		Participate in classroom activities (e.g. attempt to recite nursery rhyme/sing songs/communicate despite lack of accuracy and fluency)						
	LO 2							
	Demonstrate ability to speak clearly	Pronounce words accurately with support						
		Pronounce words accurately without support						
		Vary intonation according to purpose (statement, interrogation, exclamation,)						
		Vary intonation, pitch and pace according to purpose and situation (e.g. storytelling, dialogue)						
	LO 3							
	Demonstrate ability to produce planned and spontaneous speech	Introduce oneself and peers (e.g. name, age, class)						
		Give detailed information about oneself and others (e.g. family, hobbies)						
		Talk about familiar topics, giving details (e.g. holidays, favourite food, environment)						
		Participate in a range of oral activities (e.g. presentation, role play, dramatisation)						
		Engage in and sustain a short exchange about oneself or a familiar topic						

	LO 4						
	Demonstrate ability to relate events and stories	Convey gist of events or stories using single words or phrases with the help of prompts					
		Narrate events/incidents from everyday life or oral text with growing independence					
		Organise thoughts and information in a coherent manner					
		Describe in some detail events, characters etc. (e.g. use adjectives, adverbs)					
		Situate action in time (use correct verb tenses)					
	LO 5						
	Express appreciation of stories and events	Express likes and dislikes using short responses (e.g. characters in stories/films, a personal experience)					
		Express views on stories and familiar topics or events related to oneself (e.g. I had fun at the beach.)					
		Provide some reasons for views (e.g. I had fun because I built sand castles.)					
	LO 6						
	Demonstrate awareness of social norms and conventions	Greet one another (e.g. Hello, Good morning)					
		Use polite forms (e.g. please, thank you)					
		Ask for permission					
		Request information					
		Ask for clarification					
		Provide explanation (e.g. for absence)					
		Use appropriate register (formal/informal)					
	LO 7						
	Use different language structures and forms	Use simple sentences with support (e.g. I am..., She is..., This is...)					
		Use simple sentences without support					
		Use compound sentences (e.g. I like football but I do not like badminton.)					

		Use complex sentences (e.g. I like playing football when I am free.)							
		Use affirmative and negative forms with support							
		Use affirmative and negative forms more independently							
		Use interrogative, imperative, exclamatory forms							
Reading	Learning Outcomes	Competencies, attitude, and behaviour	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6	
	LO 1								
	Demonstrate reading readiness	Express understanding that print contains messages							
		Identify familiar print (e.g. stickers, wrap labels, posters, poems, comic strips)							
		Show understanding of some basic conventions of text and picture layout (e.g. directionality: left to right, top to bottom, and front to back format)							
		Distinguish between different parts of a book (e.g. front cover, back cover, inside pages)							
		Recognise letters of the alphabet							
		Distinguish among words, symbols and numbers							
		Recognize letter case and typeface (e.g. bold, italics)							
	LO 2								
	Demonstrate willingness and enthusiasm to engage in reading	Show interest in decoding illustrations in a story book/reading							
		Engage in shared/individual reading activities							
		Show interest in reading different genres (e.g. comic strips, story books, poems)							
		Display reading preferences (e.g. favourite author, favourite book)							
		Engage in sustained silent reading for pleasure and learning							

	LO 3						
	Demonstrate the ability to apply decoding skills	Recognise syllables in words (e.g. syllabic segmentation)					
		Use phonemic awareness to decode words (e.g. segmenting, blending, consonant clusters)					
		Recognise word and sentence boundaries					
	LO 4						
	Read with understanding	Engage in picture reading (e.g. picture description, story telling, prediction, sequencing)					
		Match pictures with words and vice versa					
		Use text attack skills to derive meaning (e.g. title, layout, paragraphing)					
		Read simple written instructions in class					
		Follow development of ideas in texts with support					
		Follow development of ideas in texts with growing independence					
		Identify key ideas in texts					
		Identify some details in texts					
		Identify specific information in texts					
		Make predictions based on information in texts with support					
		Make predictions based on information in texts with growing independence					
		Readjust predictions in relation to new information					
		Derive meaning from grammatical items (e.g. prepositions indicating positions and tenses indicate time)					
		Start to use word attack skills to derive meaning (e.g. root word, prefix, suffix, plural)					
	LO 5						
	Demonstrate ability to read with fluency and accuracy	Read aloud with fluency under guidance					
		Read aloud fluently and with growing independence					
		Read a short text silently and fluently					
		Read on despite the presence of unfamiliar words					

	LO 6							
	Read critically and provide personal response to texts	Respond with appreciation to texts (e.g. discuss their views, draw favourite character/scene)						
		Respond empathetically to texts (e.g. role play characters)						
		Respond critically to texts (e.g. give a short personal response)						
Writing	Learning Outcomes	Competencies, attitude, and behaviour	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
	LO 1							
	Demonstrate readiness and early writing skills	Adopt appropriate seating posture for writing						
		Hold writing materials properly (e.g. pencil, pen, crayon)						
		Trace letters properly and neatly						
		Write the letters of the alphabet (e.g. capital and small letters) properly and neatly						
		Copy simple written information in a left to right, top to bottom format						
		Use the computer to type letters of the alphabet						
	LO 2							
	Demonstrate willingness and interest to engage in writing	Show enthusiasm to engage in writing activities despite lack of accuracy (e.g. greetings cards, recipes, postcards, posters)						
		Show willingness to engage in shared/individual writing activities despite lack of accuracy (e.g. posters, charts, stories, poems, informal letters, narrative and descriptive compositions)						

	LO 3							
	Demonstrate the ability to write accurately	Copy name and familiar words						
		Complete words with missing letters using given clues						
		Complete words with missing letters without given clues						
		Spell words phonetically as a strategy to write words						
		Write common words from dictation						
		Write sentences from dictation						
		Use simple vocabulary related to familiar situations						
		Use vocabulary appropriate to the situation and topic						
		Use common punctuation marks appropriately (e.g. full stop, question marks, commas, exclamation marks)						
		Use appropriate tenses to situate action in time						
		Use common conjunctions as linking words						
		Spell high-frequency words correctly						
		Write grammatically correct sentences						
		Type simple words on the computer						
	LO 4							
	Demonstrate the ability to use different sentence structures in writing	Sequence words properly to form parts of sentences						
		Complete simple sentences given a word/picture bank						
		Complete simple sentences without a word/picture bank						
		Write simple sentences						
		Write compound sentences						
		Write complex sentences						
		Type sentences on the computer						

	LO 5							
	Produce a variety of texts for different purposes and audiences	Produce short and simple texts with the help of a writing frame (e.g. poster, message, greeting cards, postcard)						
		Produce short and simple texts without a writing frame (e.g. certificate, card, letter)						
		Produce extended texts with the help of a writing frame (e.g. short story, letter)						
		Produce extended texts without the help of a writing frame						
		Produce different texts using appropriate format (e.g. letters, stories, posters, e-mails, recipes)						
		Write a variety of texts (e.g. informal letters, poems, stories, and narrative and descriptive compositions)						
		Write for different purposes (e.g. to invite, narrate, inform, explain, express opinion)						
		Use the computer to write short texts (e.g. e-mail, diary entry, short paragraph)						
	LO 6							
	Demonstrate the ability to write coherent and well-structured texts	Sequence ideas (sentences and paragraphs) to produce a logical flow						
		Use simple cohesive devices to structure writing						
	LO 7							
	Demonstrate ability to follow the stages of process writing	Plan and draft extended texts (e.g. understand topic, generate appropriate ideas, sequence ideas)						
		Revise and edit writing in relation to formulation of sentences and sequencing of ideas						
		Proofread writing (e.g. make corrections to lettercase, spelling, punctuation, and simple grammar)						
		Use spell-check to edit writing on the computer						

GRAMMAR

The grammar syllabus outlines the grammar items that have to be taught in the different grades. At primary level, the emphasis is on usage and grammar is not to be taught in isolation but, rather, in relation to the language skills. Thus, the grammar syllabus must be read alongside the language skills syllabus. Grammar teaching aims at equipping learners to understand and communicate in English with respect to the learning outcomes at a given Grade.

From Grades 1 to 3, basic grammatical concepts are introduced through language in use so that learners can produce simple language structures. From Grades 4 to 6, use of grammar is made more explicit to enable learners to express themselves with more accuracy.

NCF GRAMMAR SYLLABUS						
Items	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
1. Nouns	Introduce common nouns through vocabulary building Introduce use of 's' for more than one item	Plural form with 's' Frequently used gendered nouns: mother /father, boy/girl, king/queen	Words referring to persons, animals, places, things Introduce basic uncountable nouns, e.g. rice, water, sugar Gendered nouns and neutral nouns (e.g. doctor) Plural form with 'es' and 'ies'	Differentiate between common nouns and proper nouns Plural forms of nouns that are unchanged (e.g. sheep) Introduce nouns always in the plural form (e.g. glasses, scissors) Countable and uncountable nouns (all categories) Gendered nouns- animals (e.g. horse/ mare)	Frequently used collective nouns (e.g. group, team, bunch)	Frequently used abstract nouns (e.g. pollution, happiness, friendship) Form frequently used nouns from adjectives or verbs (e.g. happy - happiness, pollute- pollution)
2. Pronouns	Introduce personal pronouns: I, you, he, she, we, they Introduce interrogative pronouns: who, what, where	Personal pronoun: it Interrogative pronoun: when	Reinforce use of personal pronouns Reinforce use of interrogative pronouns	Expose to personal pronouns as object: me, you, him, her, it, us, them Possessive pronouns: mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs Interrogative pronouns: which, how, why	Use of: this, that, these, those (e.g. This dress is red.) Use of: myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves	Use of: anyone, anybody, anything, everyone, everybody, everything, someone, somebody, something, no-one, nobody, nothing

3. Adjectives	Introduce familiar adjectives	Extend range of frequently used adjectives (e.g. texture: soft, hard, rough, smooth) Commonly used opposites (e.g. big/small, tall/short, soft/hard) Possessive adjectives: my, your, his, her, our, their	Extend use of range of frequently used adjectives, e.g. sunny, good, high Extend use of range of frequently used opposites	Adjectives to describe nouns: size (e.g. small chair), age (e.g. young man), temperature (e.g. hot water), shape (e.g. oval mirror), colour (e.g. red dress), texture (e.g. rough stick) Adjectives: comparative and superlative forms - Regular forms (e.g. slow/ slower/ slowest) - Frequently used irregular forms (e.g. good/ better/ best)	Irregular forms with use of 'more' and 'most' (e.g. beautiful/ more beautiful/ most beautiful) To describe nouns: opinion (e.g. good work), shape, origin (e.g. French movie) and material (e.g. wooden spoon) Comparative and superlative: irregular forms and those with 'more' and 'most'	Form adjectives from nouns or verbs (e.g. shine-shiny; metal-metallic; wood-wooden) Use of adverbs to modify adjectives (e.g. very slow, too good)
4. Verbs and tenses	Expose to simple verbs – come, go Expose to Present Continuous Tense (actions happening at the time of speaking) Expose to Present Simple Tense (habitual actions)	Further expose to Present Continuous Tense (actions happening at the time of speaking) Present Simple Tense: Use of: am, is, are - Expose to use in simple narrative texts Future Simple (actions happening in the future)	Present Simple Tense- 'es', 'ies' Past Simple Tense: - Introduce verbs that end with 'd', 'ed' - Introduce frequently used verbs with an irregular form, e.g. was, were	Consolidate for regular verbs; extend for irregular verbs Past Simple Tense: verb 'to have' Time markers, e.g. yesterday, today, next year	Past Continuous Tense Present Perfect Tense Frequently used Phrasal verbs (e.g. take off, get out, come in)	Present Perfect Tense Past Perfect Tense Common Phrasal verbs

5. Determiners: Articles & Quantifiers	Articles: a, an	Reinforce use of: a, an	Article: 'The' - for unique and specific items, e.g. The Queen - Expose to use of 'the' as referent (e.g. I saw the boy again.) Quantifiers: - Referring to countable nouns (e.g. many, some, a few)	Reinforce use of 'the' to refer to items already mentioned Introduce use of 'the' to refer to countries consisting of a cluster of islands/states e.g. The United States, The Seychelles Quantifiers: some, few / little, many / much (referring to countable and uncountable nouns)	Expose to words taking no article (e.g. I went to school.) Expose to quantifiers: both, all, enough, less, more
6. Adverbs			Use of Adverbs of: - manner - with 'ly' - Place - here, there - Time - after, before	Adverbs of frequency (e.g. often, never)	Adverbs of degree, e.g. very, really, so
7. Modals		Use of 'can' to convey ability: e.g. I can swim.	Use of 'May': to ask for permission, e.g. May I go to the toilet, please?	Use of 'Must' to express: - Obligation (e.g. You must come to school on time.) - Necessity (e.g. You must drink your medicine on time.)	Use of 'Might': - To convey possibility (e.g. He might come.)
8. Prepositions	Introduce: in, on, under, in front of, behind	Use of: before, after, between	Use of: against, above, below, from...to	Extend range to include: - Direction (e.g. He drove towards Port-Louis.) - Time (e.g. on Tuesday, during the week)	Use of: for, with, without
		Use of: next to			

9. Sentence Structure	Introduce to sentence boundaries (Capital letter and full stop) Understand simple instructions Start to form simple sentences and questions orally	Simple affirmative and negative sentences using: I can / I cannot	Reinforce sentence boundaries Construction of simple sentences Negative form: is / are not; does / do not Introduce interrogative form	Extend use of negative form (e.g. He is not sad.) Extend use of interrogative form (e.g. Is he sad?) Introduce questions with tags orally (e.g. She is happy, isn't she?) Expose to exclamatory form (e.g. There he is!)	Sentences in Direct speech Introduce to the construction of compound sentences using 'and' and 'but' (e.g. I ate an apple and I drank juice.)	Introduce to formation of complex sentences using relative pronouns: who, which, that, whose, where, when, why (e.g. While I waited, I ate an apple.) Introduce to sentences in Present Conditional
10. Punctuation	Full stop and capital letter (in relation to sentence boundaries) Capital letters for proper names	Full stop Question mark	Capital letter: days of the week Comma to separate items in a list	Question mark Exclamation mark Apostrophe: - in contractions (e.g. It's raining, isn't it?) - to indicate possessive form (e.g. The baby's toy.)	Direct speech: - Inverted commas - Capital letter for the first word (e.g. Ben said, "She is my sister.") - Comma in direct speech (e.g. She said, "I am so hungry.") - Comma for addressee in direct speech (e.g. "Leena, please lend me your pencil.")	Comma in addresses in sentences (e.g. This parcel should be sent to 51, Hillview Avenue, Quatre Bornes.)
11. Conjunctions		Use of 'and' to join two items	but, or	because	Extend range: as, before, however, although	Use of conjunctions for various purposes: - Reason (e.g. because, as, for) - Purpose (e.g. so that) - Place (e.g. where) - Duration (e.g. while) - Condition (e.g. if) - Cause and effect (e.g. so that, therefore) - Choice (e.g. either... or..., neither...nor...)

PHONICS

The phonics syllabus categorises the phonemes that have to be taught in the initial grades according to their level of difficulty. From Grades 1 to 4, the development of phonemic awareness aims at empowering learners to become effective readers and spell words correctly through the application of decoding strategies. In Grades 5 and 6, phonemic awareness is reinforced as required to improve the learners' pronunciation, reading and writing skills.

PHONICS						
Phonemes	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4	Grade 5	Grade 6
Consonants & Vowels	/b/	/m/	/e/	Reinforce	Reinforce according to learners' needs	Reinforce according to learners' needs
	/m/	/s/	/l/	/ʌ/		
	/f/	/l/	/k/	/j/ - 'y'		
	/s/	/p/	/ɒ/	/dʒ/ (e.g. joke)		
	/d/	/l/	/h/			
	/n/	/d/	/v/	Introduce orally:		
	/æ/	/e/	/j/ - 'y'	/ʒ/ (e.g. pleasure)		
	/k/	/f/	/z/	/ə/ (e.g. The)		
	/h/	/k/ - 'k', 'c', 'ck', 'qu'	/æ/ (e.g. cat)	/ə:/ (e.g. bird)		
	/e/	/r/	/dʒ/ (e.g. joke)			
	/p/	/s/				
	/l/	/ɒ/ (e.g. fox)	/ʌ/ (e.g. cup)			
	/t/	/ð/ (e.g. their)				
	/ɔ/	/θ/ (e.g. thick)				
	/v/					
	/j/ - 'y'					
	/g/					
	/ɪ/					
	/w/					
	/u/					
	/ʃ/ - 'sh'					
	/tʃ/ - 'ch'					

Consonant blends		bl	/ð/ (e.g. their)	str		
		cl	/θ/ (e.g. thick)	spr		
		fl		sch		
		pl		shr ...		
		gl	Reinforce /l/, /r/, /s/			
		br				
		fr	/ŋ/ (e.g. sing)			
		tr	wh			
		dr				
		cr				
		pr				
		gr				
		sp				
		sq				
		sw				
		st				
		sk				
Vowel blends		/aɪ/	/aɪ/	Reinforce + introduce new letter combinations:		
		/əʊ/	/əʊ/	/ei/		
			/ŋ/ (e.g. sing)			
			/ɑ:/ (e.g. father)	ɪə		
			/ei/			
			əʊ			
				Introduce:		
			ɔɪ	aɪ		
			ɪə	eə		
				ʊə		
Long vowel sounds		/i:/	/i:/	ɜ:		
		/u:/	/u:/	ɔ:		
		/ɔ:/ (e.g. door)	ɔ: ɜ:			

